

board (with an animation). Tapping in the first few letters of any person's name prompts the iPhone to offer suggestions from the address book, or you can use the little "+" icon towards the top left corner to bring up the contacts list and select contacts from there. You can, obviously, enter whatever you want in the body of the mail using the virtual keyboard and then press the "Send" button at the top left corner to despatch the mail. Once that is done, the phone automatically returns to the library you were viewing.

4.2.3 E-mail

The iPhone hooks up to almost any IMAP or POP3 mail service. IMAP, of course, is best, because you can keep all your folders and mail on the server and access it from anywhere. Yahoo! Mail is IMAP, Microsoft Exchange has an IMAP option, and .Mac Mail is IMAP as well. Gmail, AOL Mail, and most ISPs' mail are POP3. Yahoo! Mail is the biggest mail service in the world, they have over a quarter of a billion users—and they are going to provide free "push" IMAP email to all iPhone customers. This isn't just IMAP email, it is push IMAP e-mail, so when you get a message, it will push it right out to the phone for you, like with a Blackberry.

The e-mail Inbox has a "Mailboxes" button at the upper left corner which takes you to your list of mailboxes such as Outbox, Drafts, and your custom folders. There is a refresh button at the lower left that fetches new mail from the server, and a compose button at the lower right to write a new mail message. The centre of the screen lists all the e-mails you've received. The list is identical to the SMS inbox right down to the blue bullet that marks unread messages. The bar at the top, as usual, reflects the number of unread email in brackets. E-mails with attachments have the familiar paperclip icon beside them.



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